Name: .....
ID: .....

Section: .....

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Faculty of Language Studies

Arab Open University

FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EL122
Writing Research

All Branches- Main
FINAL Exam

2024/ Fall Semester
Date: 9 Jan. 2025
1:00 – 3:00

Number of Exam Pages: 10 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

Instructions

Make sure you complete all the necessary information such as your name, your registration number, and your section number on this cover sheet

This exam has 3 parts

Answers must be written neatly and legibly

Spend some time at the end to revise your spelling and grammar

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Exam Part	Earned Points	Grader's Signature
Part A	/15	
Part B	/20	
Part C	/15	
Total	/50	

PART A: [15 points]
Read the following passage and respond to the prompts that follow it:

In recent years, there has been a rising awareness of mental health issues among young people. Records revealed that nearly 60% of today's youth experienced stress and anxiety daily. In a fast-paced world, where pressures constantly mount, understanding mental wellness becomes increasingly important. Many young people turn to social media for solace and connection, leading to increased feelings of isolation and anxiety. The introduction of mindfulness practices in schools and workplaces aims to combat this trend by encouraging mental well-being and emotional resilience. A pivotal study by psychologist Amy Darrow explored the effects of mindfulness on teenagers in a suburban high school, discovering significant reductions in stress levels and improved emotional regulation among students participating in daily mindfulness exercises. One noteworthy case involved a student who, after engaging in mindfulness training, significantly improved both academic performance and interpersonal relationships. In one instance, a student named Emily participated in a month-long mindfulness program and found that her grades improved by 15% following the training. Through such research, Darrow highlights the need to address mental health proactively by incorporating preventive measures, fostering open dialogues, and promoting wellness practices.

"Understanding Youth: The Importance of Mental Wellness" Emily Robinson

1. What hook technique is used in the passage? [1 point]

_____

2. What verb tense is primarily used throughout passage, and what is its purpose? [1 point]

_____

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3. When does the writer in this passage switch the verb tense, and why is the switch made? [2 points]

_____

4. Identify the thesis statement in the passage. [1 point]

_____

5. What role does mindfulness play in addressing mental health concerns among the youth, according to the passage? (This should be answered as a paraphrase and not a reiteration). [3 point]

_____

_____

_____

6. List the main points from the passage in support of the thesis. [3 points]

- _____
- _____
- _____

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6. Write a response to the passage using the "Personal Experience" method. [4 points]

Part B: [20 points]

1. **For <u>each</u> thesis statement, write <u>TWO</u> topic sentences (bearing in mind the qualities of a good topic sentence) to introduce each of the main sections of a hypothetical paper. Next, use the appropriate piece of evidence among those <u>listed below</u> to support the topic sentence you constructed (bearing in mind the proper integration process). [10 points for each thesis]**

Thesis Statement (A): Amy Darrow's psychological studies underscore mental health awareness by examining how <u>stress management</u>, <u>social media influence</u>, and

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mindfulness practices shape youthful experiences.

Topic Sentence 1: [2 point]

_____

_____

_____

Explanation of the topic sentence: [2 point]

_____

_____

_____

The "adequate" supporting evidence. [1 point]

_____

_____

_____

Topic Sentence 2: [2 points]

_____

_____

_____

***Explanation of the topic sentence:* [2 points]**

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The "adequate" supporting evidence. [1points]

Pieces of evidence for Thesis statement (A)

- An article in the *International Journal of Well-being* discusses the introduction of reflective thinking techniques in educational and occupational settings. Jones and Smith (2023) note that these practices promote mental well-being and enhance emotional resilience, offering an effective strategy to counteract the rising trend of stress and mental health issues in youth.
- In a comprehensive study published in the *Journal of Adolescent Psychology*, Darrow et al. (2023) examine the impact of mindfulness on stress among adolescents. The study demonstrates that those who engage in daily mindfulness exercises tend to experience significant reductions in stress levels, leading to improved emotional regulation and overall mental health.
- According to a recent article in the *Journal of Digital Sociology*, researchers found that young individuals who frequently seek solace on social media platforms exhibited higher levels of isolation and anxiety. The study highlighted

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the paradoxical effect of social media, where the search for connection often leads to increased feelings of loneliness.

a. **Thesis Statement (B):** Consistently permitting college students to turn in assignments late can result in adults lacking drive by encouraging procrastination, reducing responsibility, and undermining effective time management abilities.

Topic Sentence 1: [2 point]

_____

_____

_____

Explanation of the topic sentence: [2 point]

_____

_____

_____

The "adequate" supporting evidence. [1 point]

_____

_____

_____

***Topic Sentence 2:* [2 points]**

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Explanation of the topic sentence: [2 points]

The "adequate" supporting evidence. [1points]

<u>Pieces of evidence for Thesis statement (B)</u>

- A study by Steel (2007), published in the *Psychological Bulletin*, reveals that in a survey presented in *The Journal of Educational Psychology* (2016), students who regularly received deadline extensions were more likely to exhibit blame-shifting behaviors and decreased responsibility.

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- Research in *Higher Education Research & Development* (2018) indicates that students who adhere to stricter schedules develop superior time optimization skills, contributing to better academic and professional performance.

- A study by Steel (2007), published in the *Psychological Bulletin*, reveals that postponing work is often linked to short-term benefits like reduced anxiety, which can be reinforced by lenient deadlines. Allowing late work without consequence builds a habit where students continuously delay tasks for immediate relief, normalizing the phenomenon.

Part C: [15 points]

a. Read the following passage. Identify the seven connecting words and phrases and explain the function of each. [2 points each]

AI technology is advancing rapidly; however, it is essential to address ethical considerations to ensure it serves humanity positively. Many industries, such as healthcare and finance, are beginning to integrate AI into their processes. For example, AI can analyze large datasets quickly, providing insights that could improve decision-making. Also, by automating repetitive tasks, AI allows humans to focus on more creative and strategic activities. In other words, AI acts as a powerful tool to enhance human capabilities and efficiency. When implementing AI systems, companies must be cautious about data privacy and security, thus protecting user information and maintaining trust.

1. _____

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2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

b. To what does the underlined pronoun "it" refer in the passage? [1 point]

_____

End of Exam

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